

Industry ready

What you'll actually do in a graduate finance job, and how to get one.

Goldman Snacks

Summary sheet

Audit basics

- The auditor gives an opinion on whether the accounts are true and fair.
- Assertions: existence, completeness, accuracy, valuation, cut-off, rights and obligations.
- Evidence: inspection, observation, confirmation, recalculation, analytical review, enquiry.

Practical bookkeeping

- Bank reconciliation: adjust the cash book for bank items, then reconcile for timing differences.
- VAT: output VAT on sales – input VAT on purchases = amount due to HMRC.
- Control accounts check the sales and purchases ledgers.

Group accounts

- Control (usually over 50%) = subsidiary, consolidated in full.
- Significant influence (20–50%) = associate, equity method.
- Goodwill = consideration + NCI – fair value of net assets.

Interview prep

- Use STAR: situation, task, action, result.
- Know the three statements and how they link.
- Prepare questions to ask the interviewer.

Excel skills

- SUMIFS and XLOOKUP (or VLOOKUP) for pulling figures.
- Absolute references (\$A\$1) stay fixed when copied.
- Pivot tables to summarise large data sets.

Reading an annual report

- Strategic report: the business model, risks and KPIs.
- Auditor's report: an unmodified opinion is a clean one.
- Notes explain accounting policies and the numbers in the statements.